

Annotated Bibliography

Safaei, A., Bilgen, A., & Morid, S. (2026). Conflictual cooperation in transboundary waters: Insights from the Euphrates–Tigris Basin. *Water International*, 51(6), 741–764.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/02508060.2026.2670927>

This article examines how countries within the same river basin can be simultaneously cooperative and conflictual in resolving issues related to water rights. This breaks away from the traditional binary understanding of the ‘water wars’ which state that countries will ultimately go into conflict over water scarcity, thus stating that full out war or diplomacy are not the only two options. The Euphrates-Tigris river basin is used as the main example in this article.

Dinar, S., Katz, D., De Stefano, L., & Blankespoor, B. (2019). Do treaties matter? Climate change, water variability, and cooperation along transboundary river basins. *Political Geography*, 69, 162–172. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.polgeo.2018.08.007>

This article is an analysis of cooperation between countries who have signed agreements regarding transboundary rivers. It argues that while the presence of a single treaty does not have a significant impact on the amount of cooperation, a series of treaties does have a significant impact in cooperation. This implies that while an initial agreement may be flawed, subsequent treaties fix these issues.

Offutt, A. (2022). Mixing waters: Stakeholder influence in transboundary water conflict and cooperation. *Water International*, 47(4), 583–609.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/02508060.2022.2059322>

This article analyzes how domestic stakeholders in water usage can pressure governments to cooperate and influence transboundary water treaties. The relative risk to shareholders in the operations of water management force governments to evaluate the impacts of water treaties.

USBR. (2025). *Boulder Canyon Operations Office | Lower Colorado Region | Bureau of Reclamation* [PDF]. <https://www.usbr.gov/lc/region/g4000/wtracct.html>

This Website includes multiple PDFs including data regarding the water usage in the lower Colorado basin. This lower basin specifically includes Arizona, California, Nevada, and Mexico. Each PDF is specific to one year’s data.